prices. This was larger than the GVA for the mining and quarrying sector (Rs 3.89 lakh crore). As sectoral inflation dynamics differ with some products witnessing higher inflation than others, in some cases, the real growth is different when calculated in terms of constant prices and current prices. This happens to be the case in the utilities sector. In constant prices, the mining and quarrying sector's GVA at Rs 3.66 lakh crore was much higher compared to Rs 2.74 lakh crore for the utilities sector. This discrepancy confirms that the mining and quarrying sector has witnessed disinflationary conditions, whereas the utilities sector, despite having been subsidized by the government, has seen higher inflation.

The total value of output generated in the utilities sector in 2018–19 at current prices was Rs 11.68 lakh crore. The largest value of output was generated in the electricity sector at Rs 8.23 lakh crore (70 per cent). Water supply (Rs 1.38 lakh crore), gas (Rs 1.15 lakh crore) and remediation and other utility services (Rs 0.92 lakh crore) were the other subsectors contributing to the value of output.

Construction, Barring Occasional Slippage, Saw Steady Growth until 2018–19

With the expansion of real estate and infrastructure, the construction sector is emerging as an important pillar of the economy. GVA by the construction sector in 2018–19 at current prices was Rs 13.44 lakh crore. In fact, the construction sector is larger than many other sectors of the economy—mining and quarrying, gas, electricity and water, transport services, financial services and even public services—in terms of GVA at current prices.

The details of output produced in the construction sector are available in the National Accounts for quite a few important subsectors, such as residential and non-residential dwellings, roads and bridges, other structures and land improvements, plantation construction and construction related to